ence on things and contacts supplied or given from the outside. The mind can always furnish its own furniture from within itself. Not to be able to live without things being "given," I take as a kind of passivity of mind. At first, I had a great admiration for the Western man in this respect, for no matter in what situation or time I saw him, he was always occupied with listening to music, reading, talking, or doing something. I thought it was so good to be always doing something and not being lazy or wasting time. Later, it occurred to me that too much of that kind of activity produces a passivity and an inability of the mind to be independent and just by one's self. An internal activity of mind is its natural habitat and perhaps it is not desirable to lose it. I fancy, it would be a greater punishment to a Westerner than to an Easterner, or, specifically to an Indian, to be confined to his own solitariness without any kind of contact with the external world of books, human beings, animals, pictures or sounds. Solitariness has its own rewards, which when properly cultivated enriches and develops the human mind.

Another point I want to make is about the quality of obedience in men's characters and personalities. Obedience has today a derogatory quality in terms of civic and family life. It is perhaps reserved only for military life and training. This is a quality of the age in our times, and given time it may change in the East and in India also, but today the difference exists in some measure between men from the East and from the West. It is still, in most homes and societies in the East, considered good and desirable for younger boys and girls to cultivate and practice obedience toward their parents and elders, in life at home and outside. Ordinary courtesies are responded to in India by members of the family or an organization just because a father, mother, wife, brother, or an elder wants something and for no other reason. That some things be done just because they are wanted by a relative and for no other reason is losing its hold in the West. The family may find other reasons for obedience and obey the wishes of the elders, but will resent the mere quality of obedience being attributed to them. This change is coming in the Eastern world too, but still there is a difference in this respect. An Indian son, daughter, or wife will be proud of the fact that he or she is obedient to the elder for no reason other than obedience because of the relationship of age and blood. Children today will not pick up the evening paper or a glass of water and give it to the father if asked to do so when they are watching television or listening to the stereo. They would rather ask the father to get it himself, but I was raised differently, am still different, and would like to remain so. This form of obedience